DLC

THE UNIVERSITY OF OKLAHOMA — ENERGY MANAGEMENT PROGRAM

Field Land Work & Career Opportunities

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Conversational format — questions encouraged throughout

DUDLEY

DUDLEY LAND COMPANY

SECTION 01

01

Who We Are

- Dudley Land Company — land services firm founded on the broker/field side of the business
- Offices in Katy, Oklahoma City, Pittsburgh, and Dallas (coming)
- Serve oil & gas, pipeline, utility, geothermal, solar, wind, battery storage, and lithium extraction clients
- Not an operator — we're the execution arm that operators call when they need land work done fast and at scale

PERSONAL STORY

22

YEARS AGO

I Was Exactly Where You Are

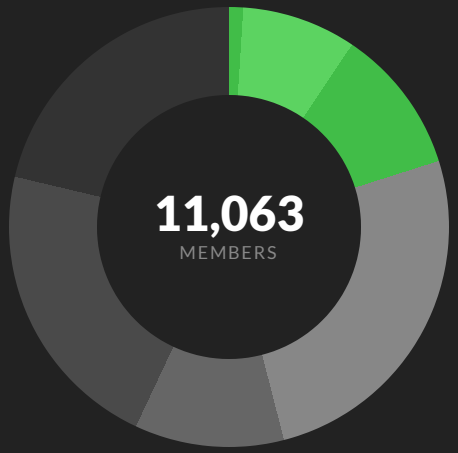
- 22 years ago — energy management student, same questions, same uncertainty
- Was the oldest of the young in the field business — same generational moment you're entering now
- Currently owner and president of Dudley Land Company
- The job I do today started from the seats you're sitting in

01

DUDLEY

01

AAPL Membership: 11,063 Members



Under 20	**<1%**
20–29	**8.4%**
30–39	**10.7%**
40–49	**25.9%**
50–59	**11%**
Over 60	**21.7%**
Unknown	**22%**

Nearly 60% of members with known ages are over 40. The "unknown" group almost certainly skews older — AAPL didn't collect birth date data until ~2010.

~80%

OVER 40

<20%

UNDER 40

WHY YOU'RE IN A GOOD SPOT

The Field Needs You — Now

- The experienced generation is aging out — not enough young professionals behind them
- M&A activity is consolidating in-house land departments — fewer in-house seats
- You don't have to go in-house at a major to have a great career in land

01

SECTION 02

02

What Is a Field Landman?

And where do you fit in the picture?

02

THE WORK

02

What Field Landmen Do

- Courthouse research, title examination, lease acquisition, right-of-way, landowner negotiations, curative work, due diligence
- The outputs: abstracts, run sheets, ownership reports, title opinions
- Skills that make you effective: research, communication, negotiation, legal interpretation, geography, relationship management

02

20

PEOPLE DEPLOYED

Where Broker Companies Fit

- Operators call DLC: “We need to run title on X tracts” or “Lease up this prospect area” — then: how much time do you have?
- Two weeks? We’ll put 20 people on it. In-house teams can’t surge like that.
- Brokers provide scalability on demand — complexity, speed, and headcount constraints drive outsourcing

02

Broker vs. In-House

In-House (The Client)

- Owns strategy — what to lease, acquire, release
- Controls budget and vendor management

Broker (The Execution Arm)

- Boots on the ground — courthouse, negotiations, curative
- Trust and track record drive repeat business

Many landmen move between both worlds — knowing both sides makes you more valuable in either.

SECTION 03

03

It’s Not Just Oil & Gas

This is the energy business.

03

DUDLEY

SECTORS

Same Core Skills — Every Energy Sector

01

Oil & Gas

Conventional & unconventional

02

Midstream

Pipelines

03

Utilities

Overhead & transmission lines

04

Renewables

Solar, wind, battery storage

05

Geothermal

Next-gen energy

06

Emerging

Lithium, data centers, mineral buying

03

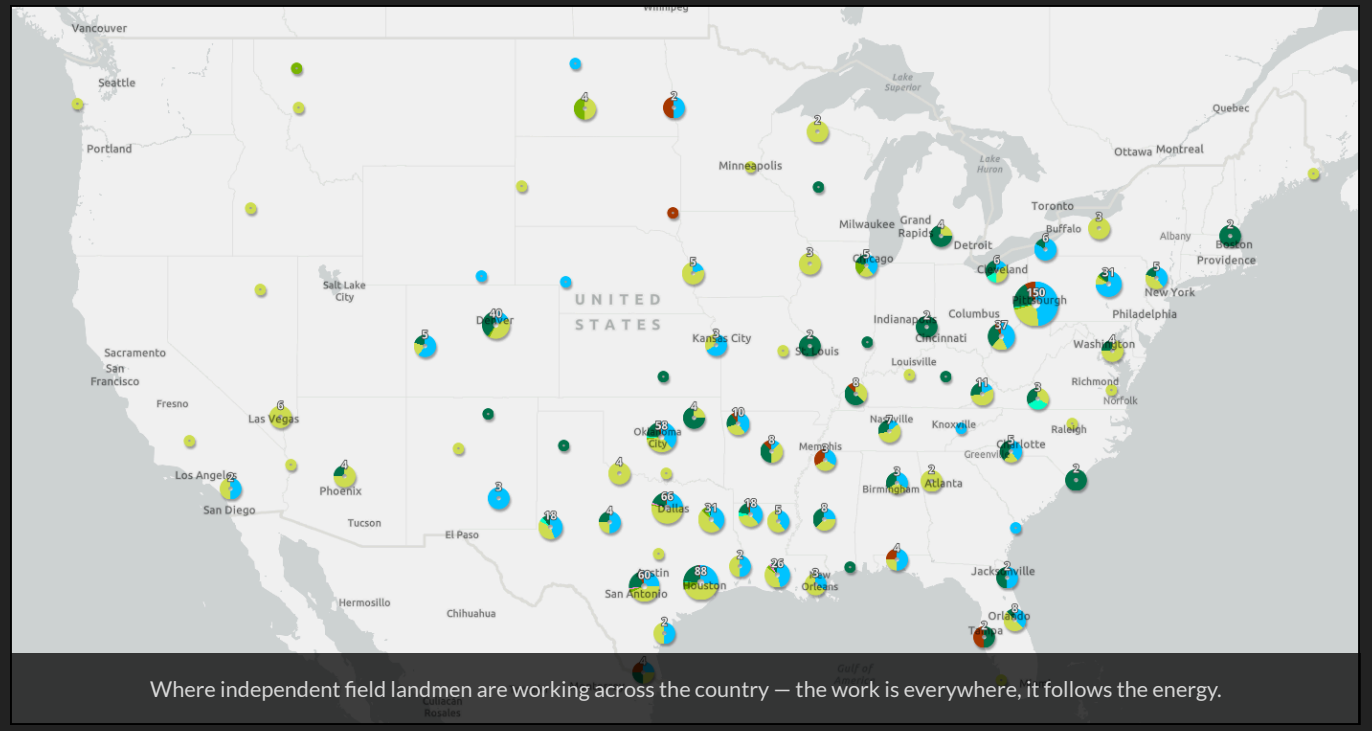
SECTION 04

04

Work Setting & Location Flexibility

- Field-based, courthouse-based, or remote capable
- You don’t have to live in Houston or Dallas — you can do this from your hometown
- Or jump on a job in Wyoming and see the country
- Geographic freedom is built into this career

FIELD LANDMAN FOOTPRINT



Where independent field landmen are working across the country — the work is everywhere, it follows the energy.

50
STATES

Every
ENERGY HUB

Remote
CAPABLE

04

Two Ways to Work in This Business

Independent / Remote

- Work from a home office
- Run your own assignments
- Location is largely your choice

Brokerage Firm Employee

- Based in an energy hub — Houston, OKC, Pittsburgh, Midland
- Office setting with a team around you
- Structured career progression

ROW work (utility/pipeline) requires more on-site presence — but neither path requires you to be somewhere you don't want to be.

SECTION 05

05

The First 3 Years

What it actually looks like — in real numbers.

05

COMPENSATION

Earning Progression

DAY 1	6 MONTHS	12 MONTHS	18 MONTHS	EXPERIENCED
$250	$275	$300	$325–350	$500–600
/day — ~$66K/yr	/day	/day — ~$80K/yr	/day — ~$90K+	/day — No ceiling

Average bachelor's degree starting salary: $66–68K. You're at parity from day one with real upside built in.

05

05

What You're Doing in Those 18 Months

01 **DAYS 1–60**
Systems orientation — how projects flow from courthouse to client

02 **MONTHS 1–6**
Guided title work under a vetted mentor — courthouse research, chain of title, curative fundamentals. 30/60/90-day checkpoints.

03 **MONTHS 6–12**
Running your own title assignments with mentor support — building regional knowledge, learning leasing and contracts

04 **MONTHS 12–18**
Increasingly independent — recognized for your skillset, evaluated for leadership track

05

DLC PROGRAM

The DLC Mentor Program

- Every trainee is paired one-on-one with a vetted, experienced crew chief
- Mentors are compensated for their time — a real investment DLC makes in your development
- Weekly check-ins, formal evaluations, structured benchmarks
- Not just thrown at a courthouse and told to figure it out

Two Tracks Into This Career

Program candidate: Industry fundamentals + commitment — faster progression, management pipeline

Non-program candidate: Broader backgrounds welcome — longer development path. Both tracks go through title. No shortcuts.

05

SECTION 06

Keys to Success

01

Technical Mastery

Title is foundational — everything else builds on it

02

Data Fluency & AI

Leverage AI tools to work more efficiently — significant early advantage

03

Relationships

Landowners, clients, attorneys, clerks — this business runs on trust

04

Reliability

Who you are in the field follows you for your whole career

05

Continuous Learning

Seek different project types, pursue certifications, understand the big picture

06

Personality Fit

Corporate in-house or courthouse & road — know which one you are and own it

06

SECTION 07

07

Your Three Career Paths

Independent. Brokerage. In-House.

07

DUDLEY

A

PATH A

Stay Independent (1099)

- Work project-to-project for various brokerage firms as a 1099 contractor
- Build your own client base and reputation over time
- Most likely working remotely from a home office
- With the right experience and reputation, you can start your own brokerage firm
- Earnings ceiling limited only by your capacity and reputation

07

B

PATH B

The Brokerage Company Track

01 Field Landman (1099)

02 Crew Chief (1099)

03 Project Coordinator

04 Project Manager

05 Regional Director

06 Vice President

07 President

07

The best of the best get identified in years 3–5 and fast-tracked.

C

PATH C

Transition to In-House

- Eventually the best field landmen get that offer — you may not want it, but you'll likely get it
- Coming in with field experience means you're significantly more prepared than someone who went straight in-house
- You'll know what it takes to get the work done, how long it should take, and you'll communicate with field counterparts far more clearly

07

SECTION 08

08

The Independent Path: Your Own Business

- 1099 contractor, not W-2 — you are a business owner
- Home office, vehicle, training, travel, and supplies are all potential tax write-offs
- Source work through relationships, broker networks, AAPL connections
- No paid vacation or traditional benefits — but no ceiling either
- The flexibility and autonomy is something most careers can't offer

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

08

DLC Contractor Requirements

01 Legitimate business entity: LLC, C Corp, S Corp, or LP — no sole proprietors

02 Dedicated business bank account — DLC pays the business, not the individual

03 Active AAPL membership required; IRWA may be required by project

04 Workers' Comp: carry your own or pay into DLC's policy

05 Background check, MVR (3 years), driver's license, auto insurance

SECTION 09

09

What About AI?

The next five years will evolve faster than the last twenty.

09

09

AI Doesn’t Replace the Landman

- Land work is relationship-based, judgment-based, and courthouse-based — AI doesn’t change that foundation
- AI can assist with research, QC, and documentation — it doesn’t replace the landman negotiating with a 75-year-old rancher in Garfield County
- The energy transition across multiple sectors is increasing demand for qualified landmen, not reducing it

09

AI Fluency Is Your Edge

- You're entering the workforce at the exact moment AI becomes a practical, everyday tool — that's a significant advantage
- The landmen who come in AI-enabled — who can extract meaningful information faster and more efficiently — will separate themselves from the pack
- This is not optional — AI fluency is becoming a baseline expectation
- Those who embrace it early will move faster, work smarter, and get noticed sooner

09

The Stack You Should Already Be Using

None of this is land-specific. That is the point — you can be fluent in all of it before your first day.

01

Capture Everything

Granola or any good transcription tool. Landowner calls, mentor sessions, site visits. In this business you get told something once, in a truck, that matters six months later. Stop relying on memory and a legal pad.

02

Work By Voice

Wispr Flow and tools like it. Dictate at talking speed instead of typing speed, and learn to navigate by voice. A small change that compounds every single day you work.

03

Agents On Your Machine

Claude Code, Codex. Not the chat window — these run against your actual folders. They organize files, read the whole stack, and help you decide. Give them real context and they give you real work back.

04

Build And Ship

Learn to find and use Skills other people have already written. GitHub, so you understand where work lives and never lose it. Vercel, so you can put something real into the world. Then go build one thing.

THE PAYOFF

09

Why It Compounds

Your mentor teaches you the hows and the whys. You still learn it by hand — that part does not change.

01 **YOU STILL LEARN IT MANUALLY**
Title fundamentals, chain of title, the reasoning behind every step. There are no shortcuts here, and none of this changes that.

02 **THE APTITUDE BUILDS IN PARALLEL**
You get fluent with the stack now, while you are still in school — not two years in, when somebody finally tells you to.

03 **THEY CONVERGE WHEN YOU GO INDEPENDENT**
Running your own assignments, your day stops going to manual typing and starts going to judgment — the tedious, important calls that actually need a landman.

04 **CLEANER WORK, EARLIER TRUST**
Your work comes back with fewer misses. You get handed independent assignments sooner. The runway compresses — and that progression is a pay schedule.

SECTION 10

10

So What Do You Do Next?

- You don’t have to land at Exxon to have a great career in land
- The field side is lucrative, flexible, and in need of young people right now
- This generation is more entrepreneurial — broker work is a viable, respected career path
- AAPL membership — start there
- RPL/CPL certification path — your energy management degree counts toward experience credit

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LET'S CONNECT

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